

E-Invoice Platform

Integration Assessment & Scoping Guide

Document Type: Internal Use Only

For: Sales & Technical Team

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Purpose

This guide helps you assess integration complexity, estimate effort, and provide accurate quotes to clients. Use this **after receiving** the client's pre-onboarding questionnaire.

Quick Assessment Framework

Step 1: Identify System Type

Match the client's system to one of these categories:

System Category	Examples	Typical Integration Path
Modern POS with API	StoreHub, Square, Lightspeed	REST API integration
Malaysian ERP	SQL Accounting, AutoCount, Million	Database connector or CSV export
E-commerce Platform	WooCommerce, Shopify, Magento	Webhook + plugin
Enterprise ERP	SAP, Oracle, Microsoft Dynamics	Middleware/API integration
Custom .NET System	Bespoke applications	Code-level integration
Legacy/Old System	DOS-based, FoxPro, dBase	File export + batch import
Manual Process	Excel invoicing	CSV template + manual upload

Integration Complexity Matrix

Low Complexity (2–4 hours)

Characteristics:

- System has documented REST API
- Pre-built adapter available or easily customizable
- Standard data format (JSON/CSV)
- Client has technical staff who can configure API calls

Examples:

- WooCommerce with official plugin
- Shopify webhook integration
- Modern POS with OAuth2 API
- System that can export clean CSV files

Integration Approach:

- Install pre-built adapter (if exists)
- OR: Provide API documentation, client implements
- OR: Simple CSV template + scheduled export

Quote Range: RM 800 – RM 1,500 (if any custom work needed)

Medium Complexity (4–12 hours)

Characteristics:

- Database accessible but no API
- File export available but requires transformation
- Custom field mapping needed
- Scheduled batch processing required
- Webhook implementation needed

Examples:

- SQL Accounting (database polling)
- AutoCount (CSV export + field mapping)
- Custom POS with SQL Server backend
- Legacy system with daily data export

Integration Approach:

- Database connector (direct SQL queries or stored procedures)

- File watcher + CSV/XML parser with custom mapping
- Scheduled job (hourly/daily batch import)
- API key authentication + validation logic

Development Tasks:

1. Database schema analysis (1 hour)
2. Data extraction logic (2-4 hours)
3. Field mapping + validation (2-3 hours)
4. Scheduling + error handling (1-2 hours)
5. Testing + documentation (2-3 hours)

Quote Range: RM 1,500 – RM 4,500

High Complexity (12–40 hours)

Characteristics:

- Enterprise system with complex data model
- Multiple systems must be integrated
- Real-time synchronization required
- Custom business logic needed
- System behind firewall (VPN/tunnel required)
- Heavy data transformation

Examples:

- SAP/Oracle ERP integration
- Multi-location retail chain (5+ POS systems)
- Legacy mainframe system
- Custom .NET system requiring code modifications
- Multi-system orchestration (POS + inventory + CRM)

Integration Approach:

- Enterprise service bus (ESB) or middleware layer
- Real-time event-driven architecture
- Complex ETL (Extract, Transform, Load) pipeline
- VPN tunnel setup (if firewall restricted)
- Custom business rules engine

Development Tasks:

1. Requirements gathering + analysis (4-8 hours)

2. Architecture design (2-4 hours)
3. Integration layer development (8-16 hours)
4. Data transformation logic (4-8 hours)
5. Error handling + retry logic (2-4 hours)
6. Testing (4-8 hours)
7. Documentation + handover (2-4 hours)

Quote Range: RM 4,500 – RM 15,000

Integration Assessment Checklist

Use this during scoping call with client:

Question 1: Data Export Capability

Q: Can your system export invoice data automatically?

- ☒ **Yes, via API** → Likely low complexity
- ☒ **Yes, via scheduled CSV/XML export** → Medium complexity
- ☒ **Yes, but requires manual export** → Medium (automation needed)
- ☒ **No, data trapped in system** → High complexity

Question 2: System Access

Q: Do we have access to the system's database or API?

- ☒ **API with documentation** → Low-medium complexity
- ☒ **Database accessible** → Medium complexity
- ☒ **File system only** → Medium-high complexity
- ☒ **No access (vendor-locked)** → Contact vendor or high complexity workaround

Question 3: Data Quality

Q: Does the system capture all LHDN-required fields?

Review client's sample invoices for:

- ☐ Seller TIN, name, address, MSIC
- ☐ Buyer TIN (for transactions > RM 10,000)
- ☐ Buyer name and address
- ☐ Invoice number, date, currency

- ☐ Line items with quantities, unit prices
- ☐ Tax type and tax rate per item
- ☐ Classification codes (product/service codes)

If 1-2 fields missing: Medium complexity (auto-fill from product master)

If 3+ fields missing: High complexity (client must fix data source first)

Question 4: Volume & Frequency

Q: How many invoices and how often?

- **< 50/month:** Manual upload acceptable (no custom work)
- **50-500/month:** Batch integration (scheduled 1-2x daily)
- **500-2,000/month:** Batch integration with high frequency (hourly)
- **> 2,000/month:** Real-time integration required

Question 5: Technical Resources

Q: Does client have in-house developer/IT staff?

- ☒ **Yes, with API experience** → They can implement, we provide docs (no charge)
- ☒ **Yes, but no API experience** → We implement, they maintain (charge for initial)
- ☒ **No technical staff** → Full-service integration (charge for dev + maintenance)

Integration Recommendation Template

After assessment, document your findings:

INTEGRATION ASSESSMENT REPORT

Client: [Name]

Date: [Date]

Assessed by: [Your name]

CURRENT SYSTEM

System: [Name & version]

Type: [POS / ERP / E-commerce / Custom]

Hosting: [Cloud / On-premise / Hybrid]

Data Access: [API / Database / File export / None]

DATA QUALITY ASSESSMENT

 Fields present: [List complete fields]

 Fields missing: [List missing fields]

 Sample quality: [Good / Fair / Poor]

INTEGRATION COMPLEXITY: [LOW / MEDIUM / HIGH]

RECOMMENDED APPROACH

Method: [API integration / Database connector / File batch / Manual]

Frequency: [Real-time / Hourly / Daily / Manual]

Data Flow: [System → E-Invoice Platform → LHDN]

ESTIMATED EFFORT

Development: [X-Y] hours

Testing: [X] hours

Documentation: [X] hours

Total: [X-Y] hours

INVESTMENT ESTIMATE

Fixed price: RM [Amount]

OR Hourly: RM [Amount] (@ RM 400/hour)

Includes:

- Initial development
- Testing & validation
- Deployment
- 1-week post-deployment support
- Basic documentation

TIMELINE

Kickoff: [Date]

Development complete: [Date]

Testing complete: [Date]

Go-live: [Date]

DEPENDENCIES

From client:

- [] Database credentials / API keys
- [] Test environment access
- [] Sample data (10+ invoices)

- [] Technical contact availability

From SteadyDevs:

- [] SOW signed
- [] 50% deposit received
- [] Developer assigned

RISKS & ASSUMPTIONS

- Client system documentation is accurate
- Test environment mirrors production
- Client provides timely feedback during development
- [Add any specific risks]

NEXT STEPS

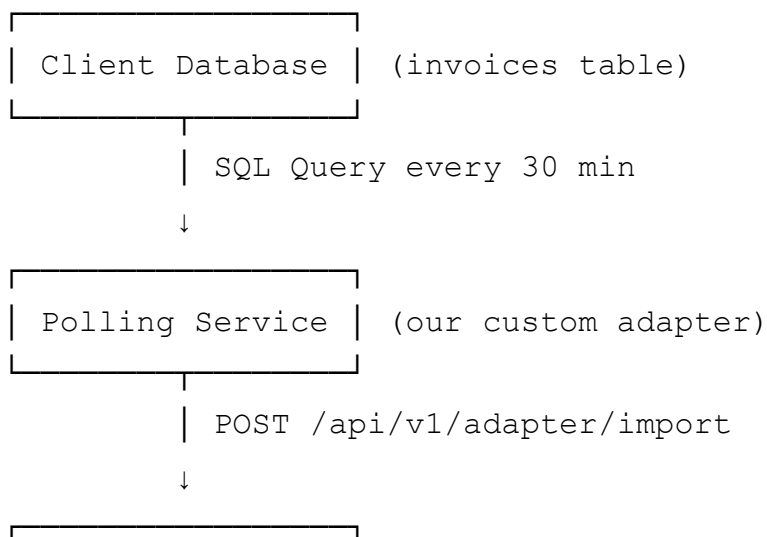
1. [] Share this assessment with client
2. [] Client approves approach & budget
3. [] Generate SOW for signature
4. [] Schedule kickoff meeting

Common Integration Patterns

Pattern 1: Database Polling (Medium Complexity)

Use Case: SQL Accounting, AutoCount, custom systems with SQL Server/MySQL

Architecture:



| E-Invoice API |

Development Checklist:

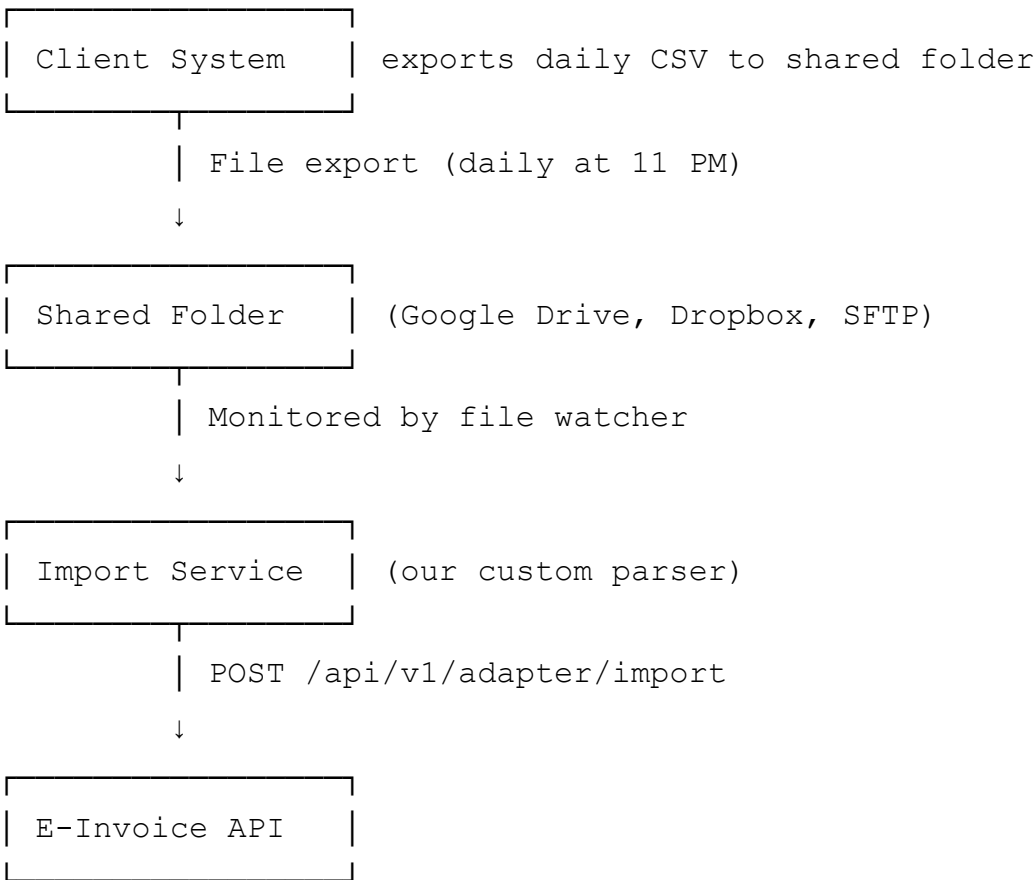
- ☐ Obtain database schema
- ☐ Write SELECT query to fetch new/updated invoices
- ☐ Map database columns to API fields
- ☐ Implement polling service (Hangfire recurring job or separate console app)
- ☐ Error handling: log failed records, retry logic
- ☐ Deploy as Windows Service or Docker container

Estimated Hours: 6-10 hours

Pattern 2: File Watcher (Medium Complexity)

Use Case: Legacy systems that export daily CSV/XML files

Architecture:



Development Checklist:

- ☐ Define CSV/XML format with client
- ☐ Build parser (handle encoding, delimiters, date formats)

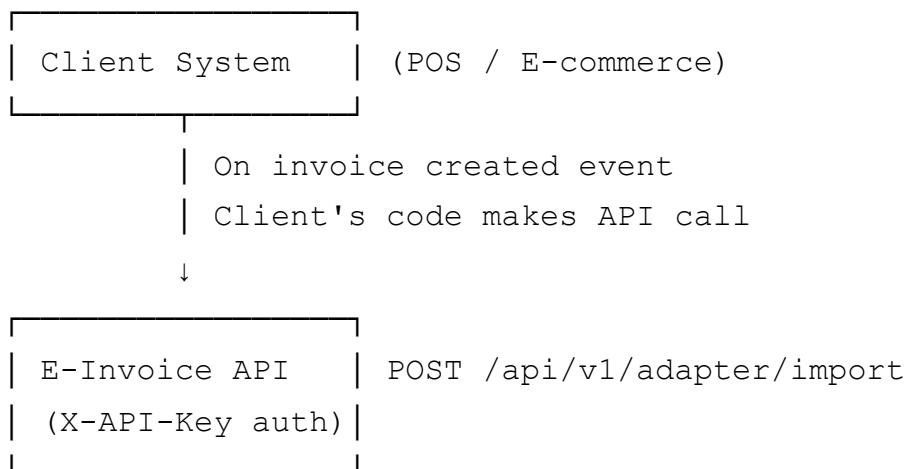
- ☐ Implement file watcher (FileSystemWatcher or cron job)
- ☐ Archive processed files
- ☐ Email notification on parse errors
- ☐ Deploy to client's server or our infrastructure

Estimated Hours: 5-8 hours

Pattern 3: REST API Push (Low Complexity)

Use Case: Modern POS/ERP with API capabilities, client has dev team

Architecture:



Development Checklist:

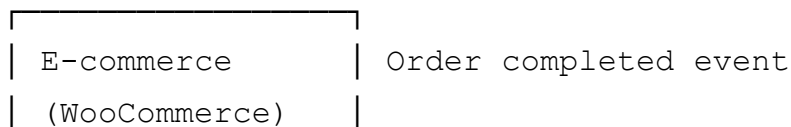
- ☐ Generate API key for client
- ☐ Provide API documentation + code samples
- ☐ Client implements HTTP POST in their system
- ☐ Test with sample payloads
- ☐ Monitor first 100 submissions for errors

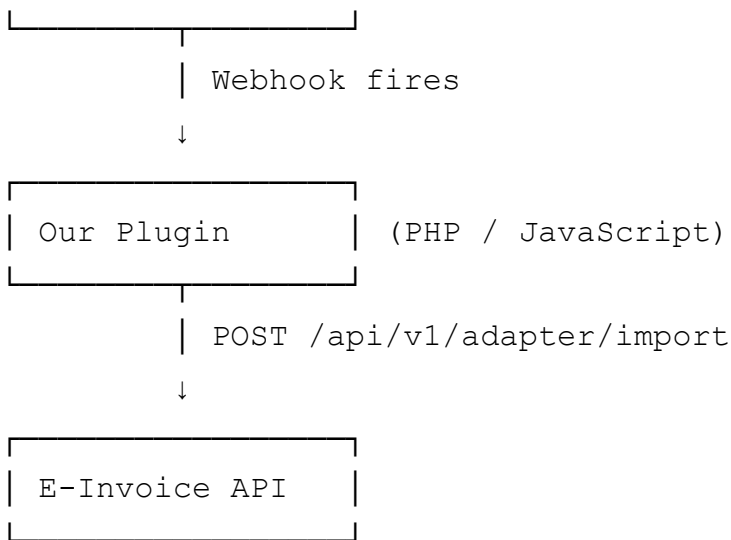
Estimated Hours: 2-4 hours (mostly support, client does the work)

Pattern 4: Webhook + Plugin (Low Complexity)

Use Case: WooCommerce, Shopify, Magento

Architecture:





Development Checklist:

- ☐ Install WooCommerce plugin (if pre-built)
- ☐ OR: Develop plugin using platform SDK
- ☐ Configure webhook endpoint in e-commerce admin
- ☐ Map order fields to invoice fields
- ☐ Test with dummy orders

Estimated Hours: 2-6 hours (depending on plugin availability)

Red Flags – When to Say No

Refuse or charge premium if:

1. Client expects full-service integration but won't pay

- "Can't you just make it work for free?"
- **Response:** Integration = custom software development = billable

2. System is completely undocumented and vendor unresponsive

- No schema, no API docs, vendor ghosting
- **Response:** Too high risk, recommend switching systems

3. Client wants real-time integration but system can't push data

- Behind firewall, no API, no database access
- **Response:** Only batch integration possible, or client must upgrade system

4. Data quality is terrible (missing 50%+ required fields)

- No buyer TINs, no product codes, inconsistent formats

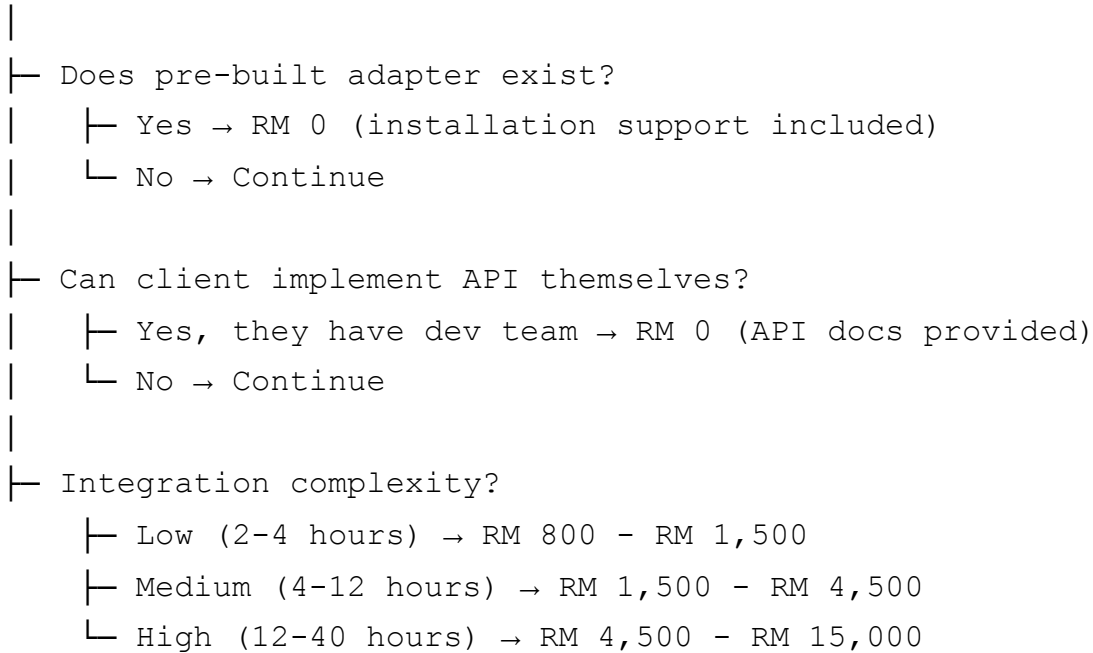
- **Response:** Client must fix data source first, we can't invent data

5. Client wants "try before you buy" integration

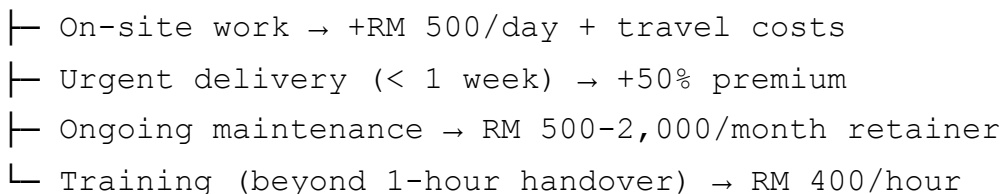
- Wants full integration built before committing to paid plan
 - **Response:** Free plan = manual CSV upload only, integration requires paid plan commitment
-

Pricing Decision Tree

Start



Additional Charges:



Integration Proposal Email Template

Subject: E-Invoice Integration Proposal for [Client Name]

Hi [Client Name],

Thank you for providing detailed information about your current system. I've completed the integration assessment and have good news – we can connect your [System Name] to the e-invoice platform.

INTEGRATION SUMMARY

Current System: [System name & version]

Integration Method: [API / Database connector / File export / Other]

Complexity: [Low / Medium / High]

Timeline: [X] weeks from project kickoff

WHAT WE'LL DELIVER

- ✓ Custom adapter that connects [System] to e-invoice platform
 - ✓ Automated data extraction ([Real-time / Hourly / Daily])
 - ✓ Field mapping and validation logic
 - ✓ Error handling with email notifications
 - ✓ Testing with your sample invoice data
 - ✓ Deployment to [production environment]
 - ✓ 1-week post-deployment support
 - ✓ Integration documentation
-

INVESTMENT

Development (fixed price): RM [Amount]

OR

Hourly billing: [X-Y] hours @ RM 400/hour

Payment Terms: 50% upfront, 50% upon successful deployment

TIMELINE

Week 1: Kickoff + requirements validation

Week 2-[X]: Development + testing

Week [X+1]: Deployment + go-live

Week [X+2]: Post-deployment support

Target Go-Live: [Date]

NEXT STEPS

If you'd like to proceed:

1. Review the attached Statement of Work (SOW)
2. Sign and return the SOW
3. We'll send the first invoice (50% deposit)
4. Schedule kickoff meeting

Questions? I'm happy to jump on a call to discuss further.

Best regards,
[Your name]

Document Control

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